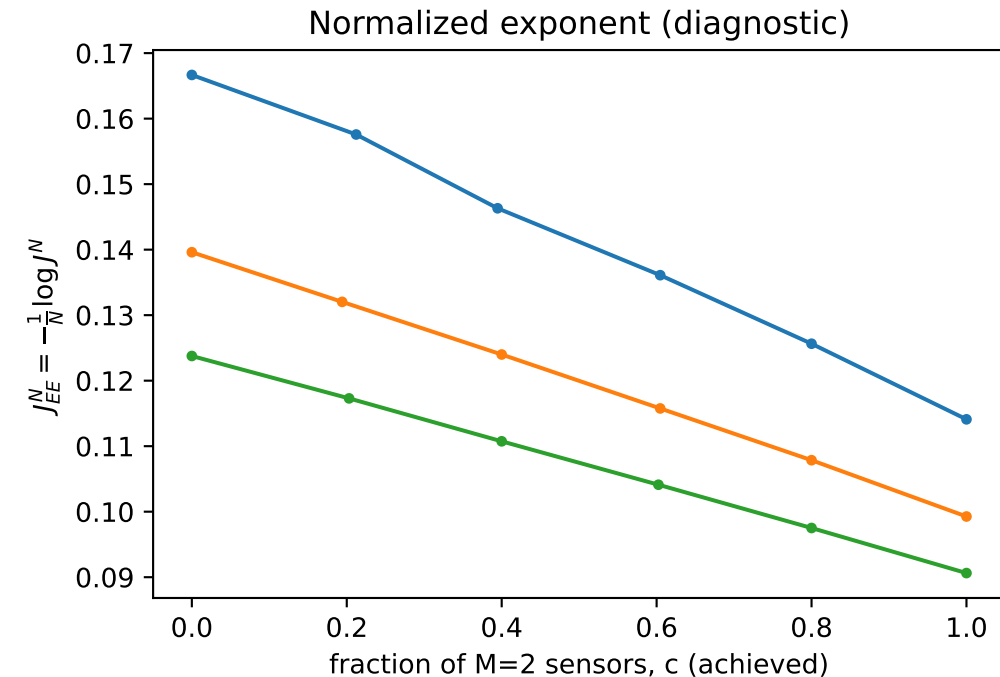
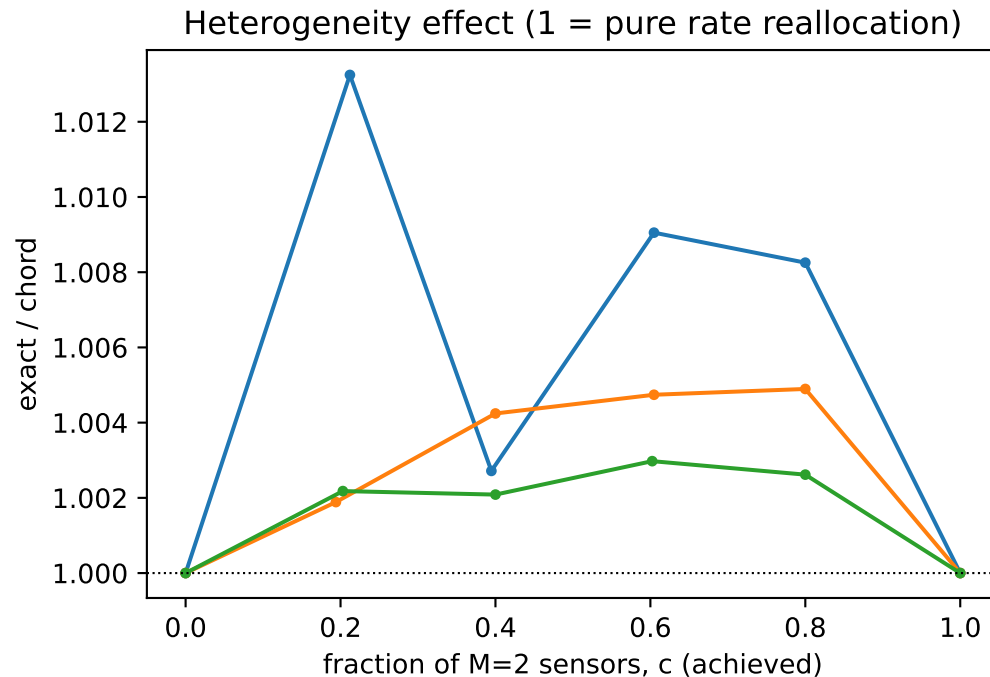
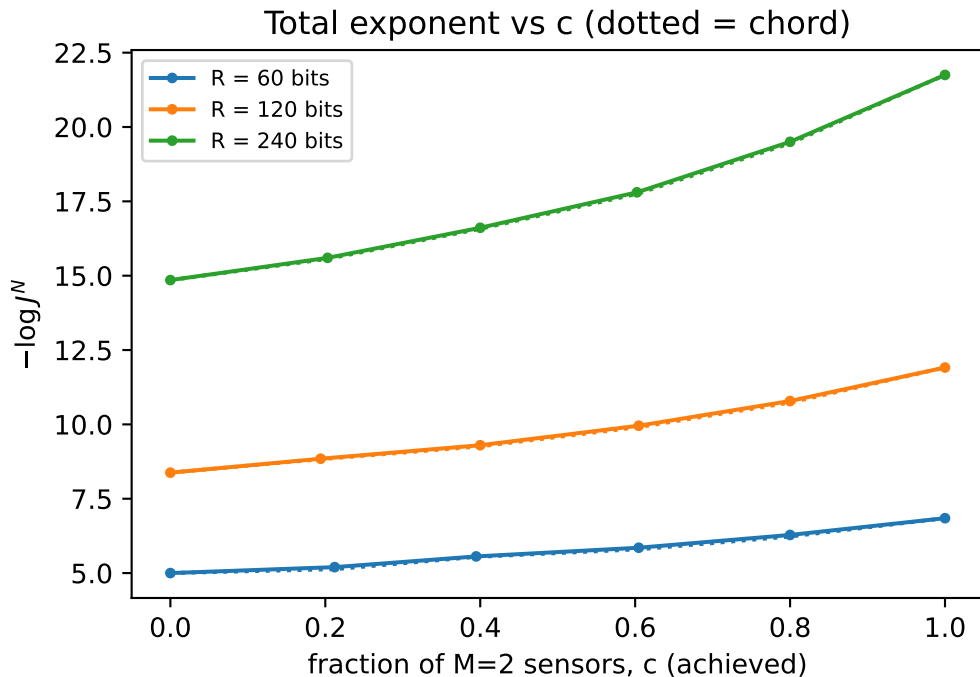


c-sweep M=2/M=4 at matched total rate, SNR 0 dB



Endpoints $c=0$ (all M=4) and $c=1$ (all M=2) are homogeneous, inside Assumption 1(iii); interior points are outside it. All banks at one rate target share the same total rate via $N = \text{round}(R/(2-c))$. Dotted chord = rate-weighted mix of the endpoint exponents; the exact/chord ratio in panel 2 isolates the heterogeneity effect from the M=2 vs M=4 bit-efficiency effect. Panel 3 divides by N , which varies with c .